

GRIFFIN ARKILIC

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SUMMARY

AI solution architect and product leader with 9+ years shipping consumer mobile and enterprise AI systems, including paid and free products that have reached millions of users worldwide. Architects agentic AI workflow automation for federal clients on AWS GovCloud and Azure Government, leads product for a net-new UAS autonomy offering, and serves as technical lead on competitive contract bids across DoD and civil agencies. Builds hands-on with Python, TypeScript, Swift/SwiftUI, React, Next.js, the Anthropic API, and MCP servers. Ships and maintains three live independent products alongside enterprise delivery. Active Top Secret clearance.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Booz Allen Hamilton | Los Angeles, CA

2022 - Present

AI Solution Architect

2025 - Present

- Lead end-to-end product development for a net-new hardware/software offering in the firm's autonomy business, taking an uncrewed aerial systems (UAS) product from concept through field testing and defining the go-to-market strategy for an emerging defense market.
- Architect and deliver agentic AI workflow automation for 2 federal enterprise clients, building multi-step tool-calling systems on AWS GovCloud and Azure Government with Azure OpenAI and Amazon Bedrock model endpoints, now in production for thousands of government users.
- Took 2 internal AI software products to market across business units of 500-2,000 employees, defining positioning, use cases, and adoption strategy in partnership with product and leadership teams.
- Serve as primary technical and delivery lead on 4 competitive contract bids plus supporting RFIs and RFPs, translating client mission requirements into solution architectures that converted into multi-year task orders.

Technical Product Lead (Associate)

2024 - 2025

- Stood up a net-new AI tech scouting practice with a team of 4, building an MVP on modern AI tooling that cut report turnaround from months to a single day.
- Authored enterprise research on deepfakes, mis-/disinformation, agentic AI, and humanoid robotics; the deepfake report became the first tech scouting research ever presented at BoozCon, the firm's annual technology conference.
- Advised 20 DoD and civil clients on AI and network security adoption from exploration through implementation, converting advisory engagements into follow-on work for the firm.

Technical Product Strategist (Senior Consultant)

2022 - 2024

- Delivered a \$1M cost-reduction plan to a cybersecurity client by synthesizing vendor and threat research into an actionable consolidation roadmap.
- Productized internal tech scouting research into a standalone offering — strategy, MVP, and a pricing model sellable outside traditional contract vehicles — piloted internally and adopted as the basis for the firm's tech scouting practice.
- Built the corporate venture team's deal-sourcing pipeline using AI-driven research tools and an industry contact network, surfacing 20+ investment opportunities, advancing 4 to full diligence, and producing a closed investment.

FitLab (acquired Fitplan) | Oakland, CA

2019 - 2022

Product Manager, FitLab

2021 - 2022

- Ran agile delivery for a distributed cross-functional team of 5-8 designers, engineers, and fitness experts across US and overseas time zones, sustaining continuous release of new features and products.
- Validated the FightLab MVP through direct outreach to fitness influencers, converting early adopters into \$15,000 in pre-purchases ahead of build.
- Defined content-product fit with fitness creators and internal stakeholders, shipping creator-led branded training programs that became FitLab's primary differentiator against competing platforms.

- Owned product decisions for a team of engineers and UI/UX designers through iterative release cycles, delivering \$8M in sales and a 62% retention increase within one year.
- Opened the OTT (over-the-top) channel by running user research and aligning executive priorities, launching Fitplan on Samsung TV to 4M+ downloads.
- Raised Fitplan's App Store rating from 4.2 to 4.8 stars by designing review feedback loops that surfaced and prioritized customer concerns, moving the app into the iOS Top 100 Health & Fitness category.

Research Made | Co-founder | San Luis Obispo, CA

2017 - 2019

- Recruited and led a 5-person engineering team, introducing scrum practice over 14 months to ship a research collaboration beta that acquired 30 university researchers as first users.

FirststepForward | Founder | San Luis Obispo, CA

2016 - 2017

- Raised a \$5K pre-seed from a local venture capital firm on market research and a product roadmap, then designed the full high-fidelity prototype and user story set for the platform.

PROJECTS & INDEPENDENT PRODUCTS

Ships new independent products continuously as a solo builder — full catalog at griffinarkilic.com/portfolio.

Solution Threads

Custom mini-SaaS for enterprise teams whose software doesn't exist

- Designed, built, and shipped custom software for 9 enterprise clients as a solo operator, delivering each engagement from scope to production in 1-3 months.
- Built on Next.js, React, TypeScript, Supabase (PostgreSQL, pgvector), and Vercel, with Anthropic API integrations and MCP servers for agentic tool use.

Spend Later

iOS app that delays impulse purchases to curb overspending

- Designed, built, and shipped a native SwiftUI app to the App Store end to end as a solo developer, maintaining a 5.0-star average App Store rating.

Free Job Tracker

Free web app for tracking job applications, with AI-assisted features

- Built and launched on Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase, and Vercel with Anthropic API integration, growing to hundreds of active users entirely through organic word of mouth.

SKILLS

Languages: Swift, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL, HTML/CSS

Frameworks: SwiftUI, React, Next.js, Node.js, Tailwind CSS

AI & ML: Anthropic API, OpenAI API, Azure OpenAI, Amazon Bedrock, MCP (Model Context Protocol) servers, RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation), vector databases (pgvector), agentic workflows, tool use / function calling, structured outputs, prompt engineering, system prompt design

Cloud & Data: AWS, AWS GovCloud, Azure, Azure Government, Supabase, PostgreSQL, Vercel, REST APIs

Developer Tools: Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, Git, GitHub, Xcode, TestFlight, App Store Connect

Product & Delivery: Product Strategy, Roadmapping, Go-to-Market, Agile, Scrum, User Research, Technical Solutioning, RFI/RFP Response, Figma, Jira

EDUCATION

Cal Poly, San Luis Obispo | Bachelor of Science in Kinesiology, Minor in Entrepreneurship